

hi! my name is Alice Qiu.
Qiu like the letter 'q'.



it's actually pronounced Qiu,
kind of like 'chiu' or 'chew'.



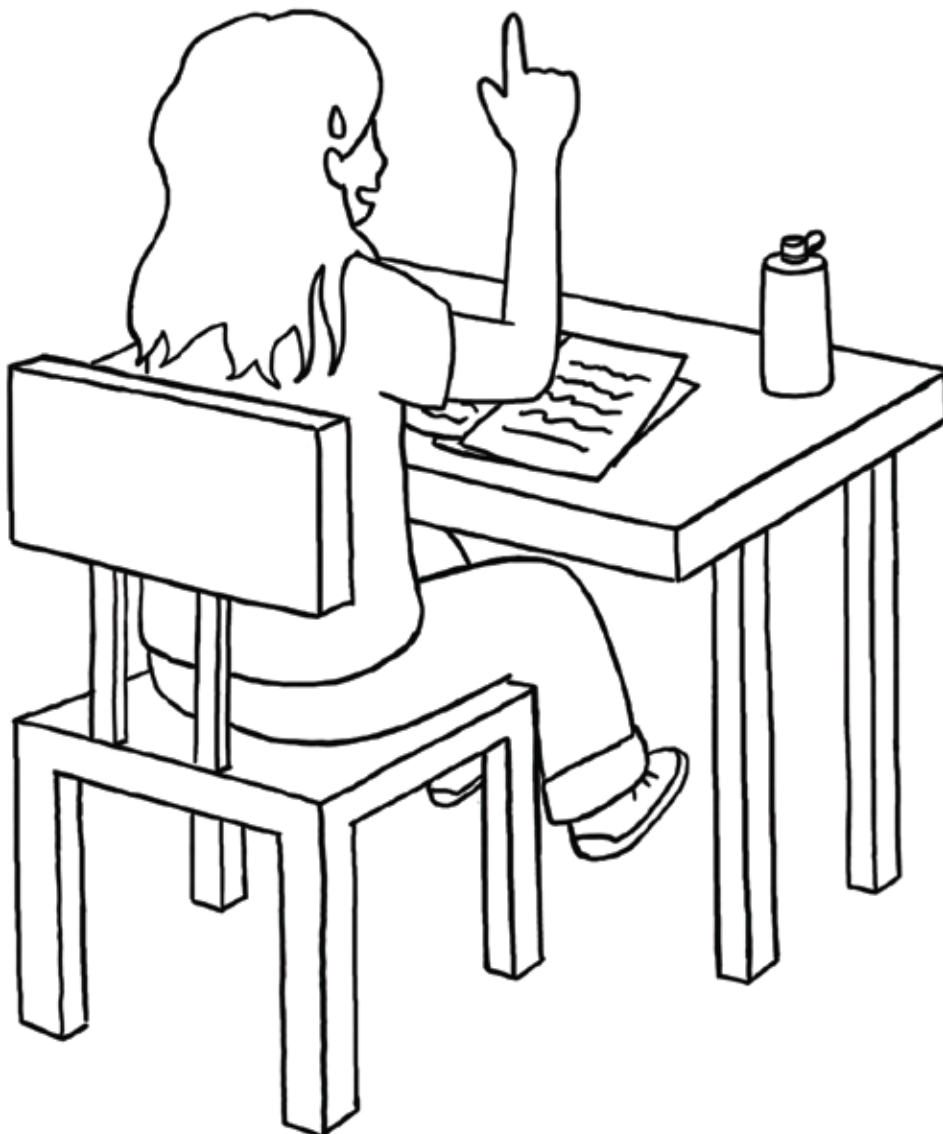
but i tell people it's Qiu,
kind of like the letter 'q'.

because if people are
going to pronounce it
wrong,

Alice...um, Qui?

actually...

i want them to pronounce it
wrong on my terms.

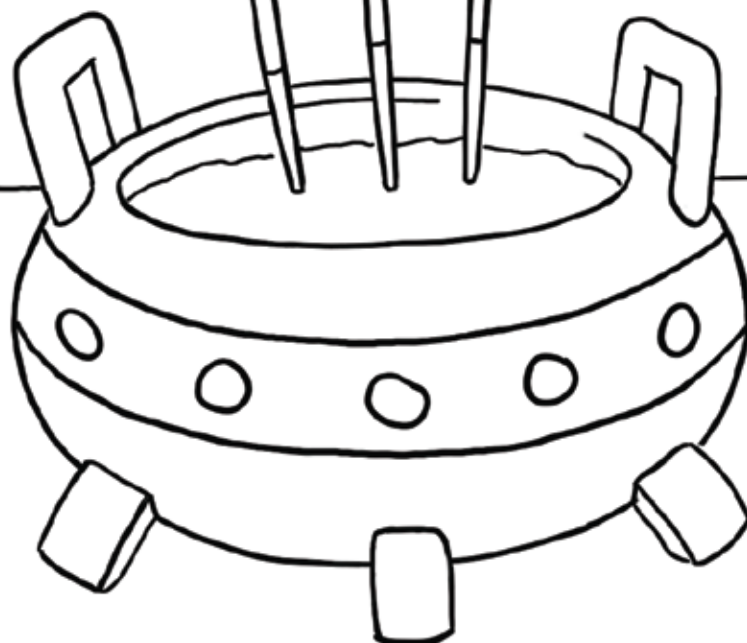


my name, at least my Chinese one,

means a lot to me.

my grandpa on my
dad's side named
me after my aunt
on my mom's side

because she passed
away one year and
two days before i
was born.



so,

what's in a name? that which we
call a rose by any other name
would smell as sweet.



i believe names can mean a lot.
even a seemingly mundane name like
John or Jane can hold significant
cultural and personal personal meaning
for the beholder, yet simultaneously
meaning nothing to someone else.

things i've been called:

☒ Alice Qiu

☒ 邱忆莎

☒ keshi

☐ best daught

☐

it's a large part of our identity and it can represent a lot, especially when someone has more than one name

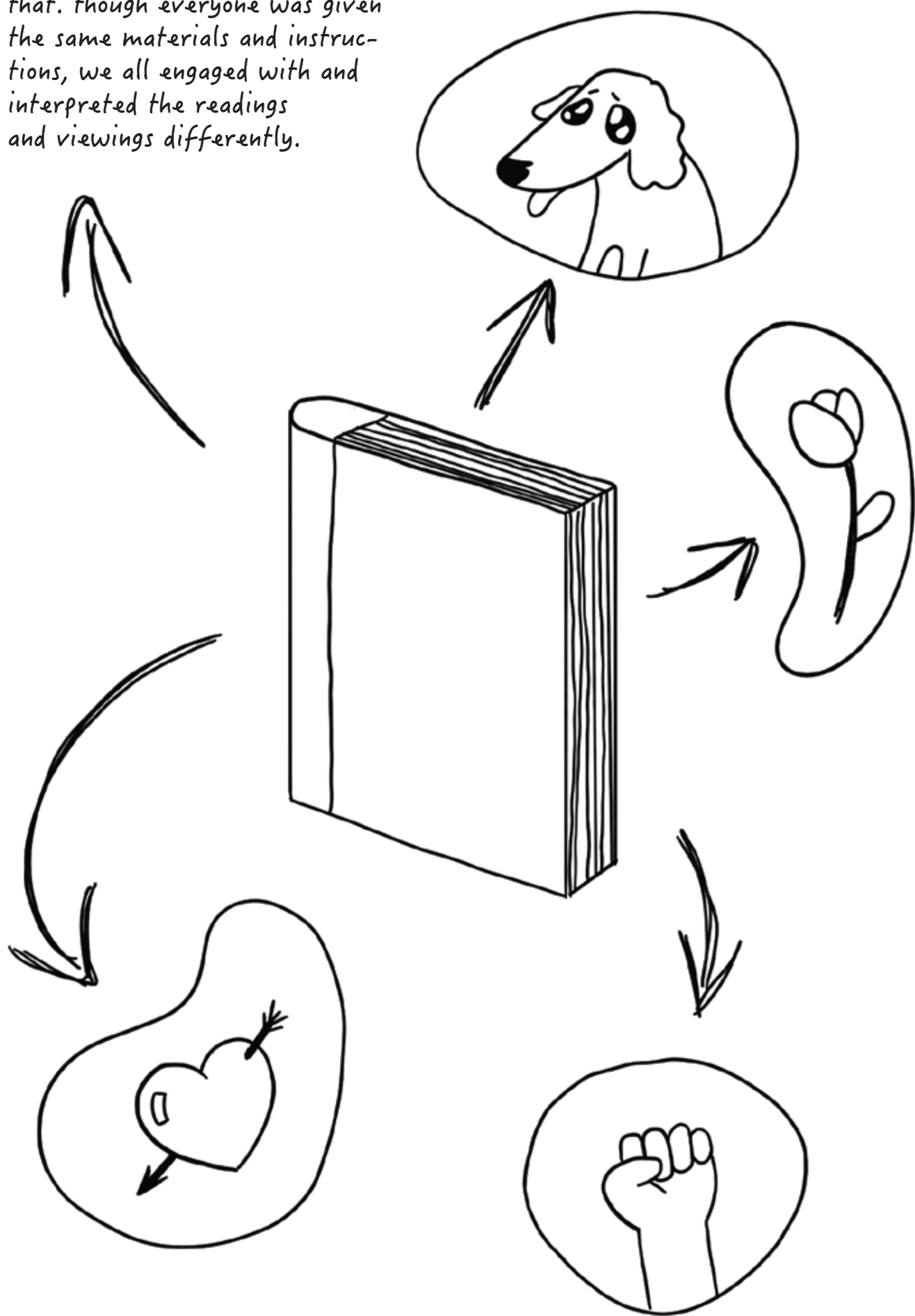
names shape how we see ourselves and how others see us. they are kind of like stories that way.

stories and media are means of
conveying information and
shaping our understanding
of ourselves and the world
around us.

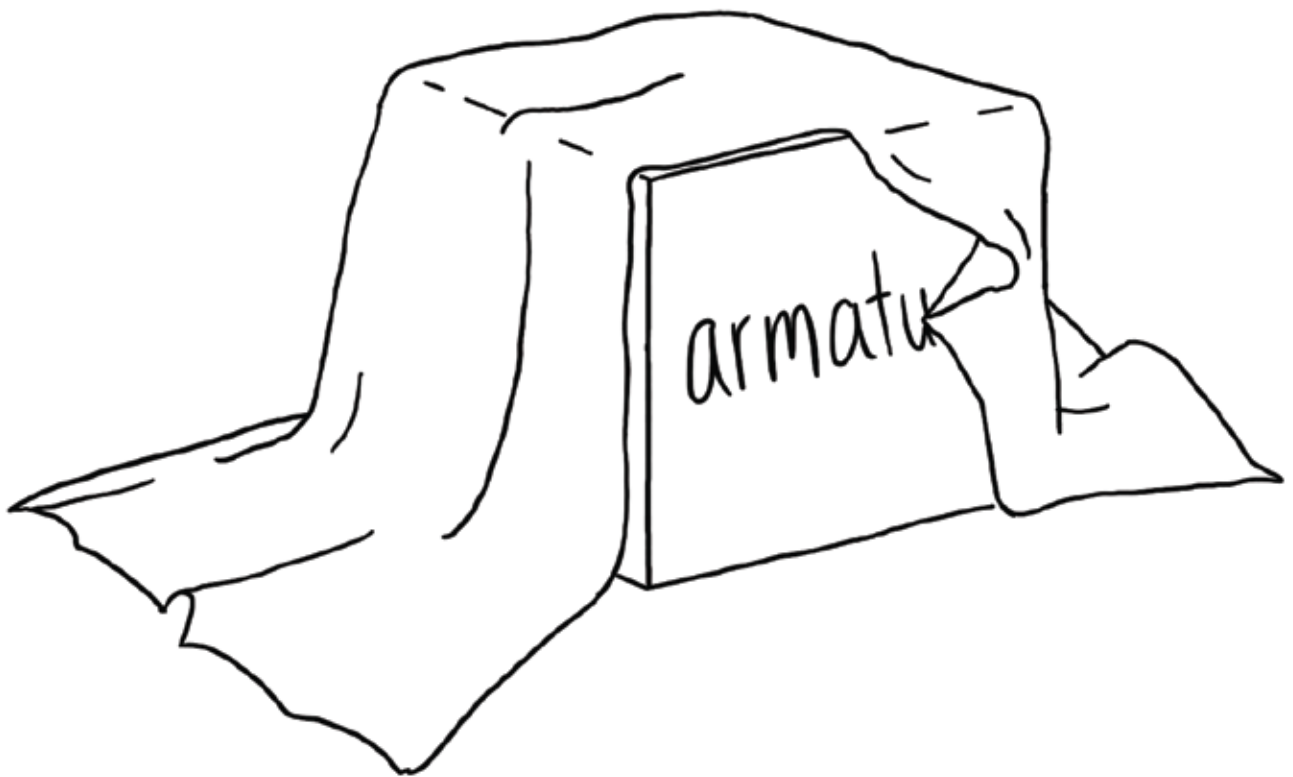
they can be used to create
narratives about individuals,
communities, entire societies
as well as transmit knowledge
and values.



i think this class really exemplified that. though everyone was given the same materials and instructions, we all engaged with and interpreted the readings and viewings differently.



and i think that's because each of us have different experiences and understandings of ourselves and of the world.



which i believe to be the hidden armature that's shaped and structured the work i've done for this class.

i engaged with the class material
in ways that made the most sense
to me.



it's how i interact with
the world around me,
really.

like for "The Half of It", i chose to write a scene about Ellie and Aster getting together in the end, because that's what made the most sense to me and was what i wanted to see for them and for myself.

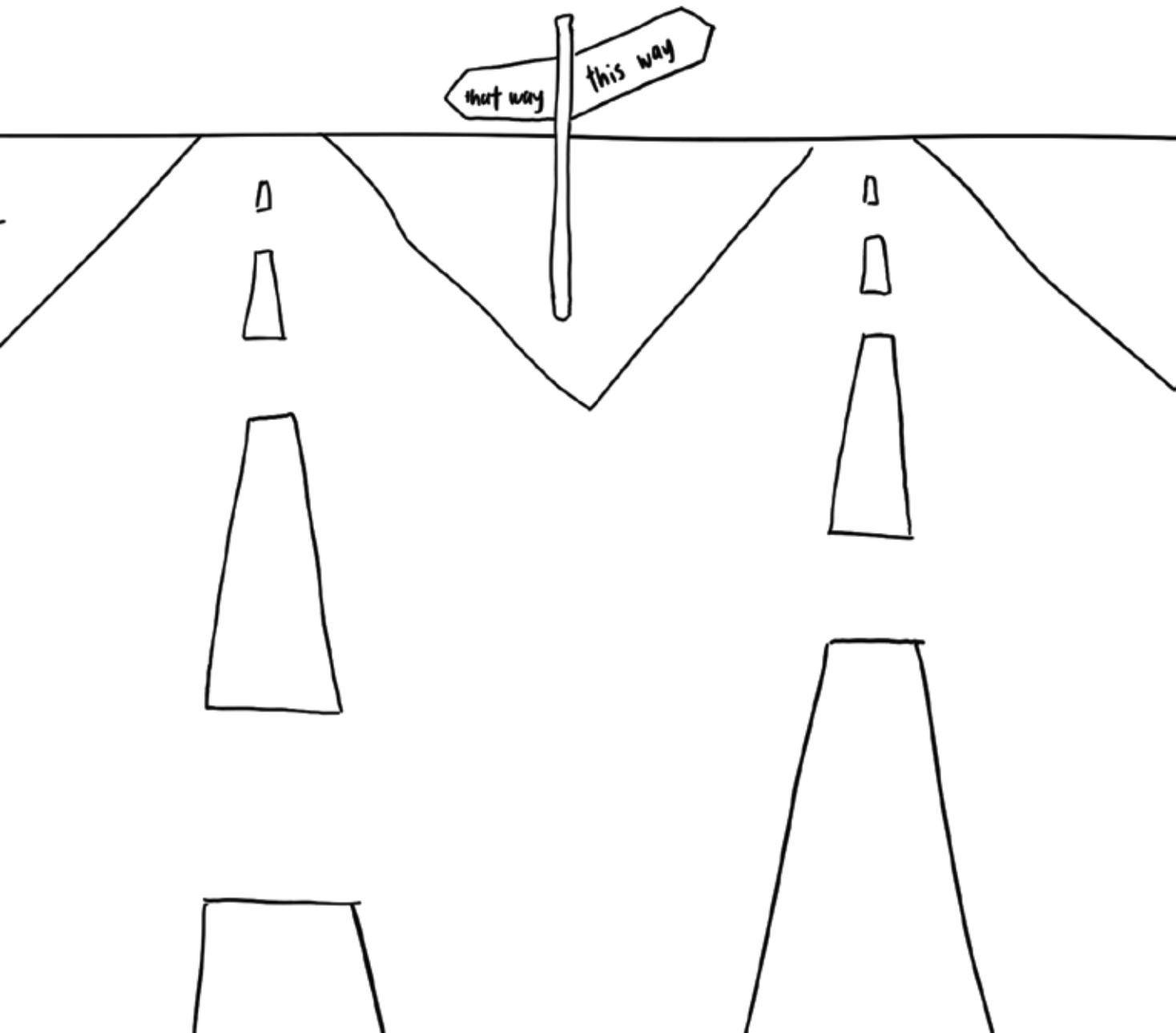
the all of it

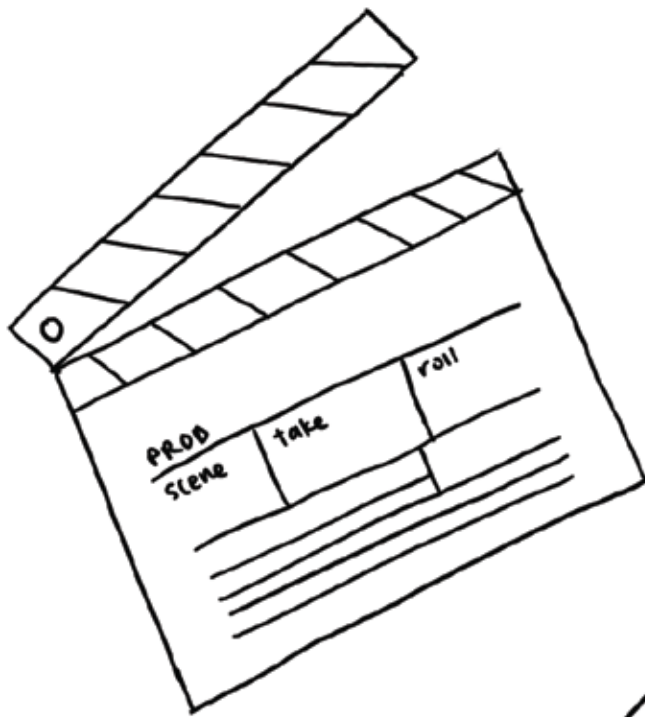
after all, who
doesn't want to fall
in love, get the
girl, and feel
whole.





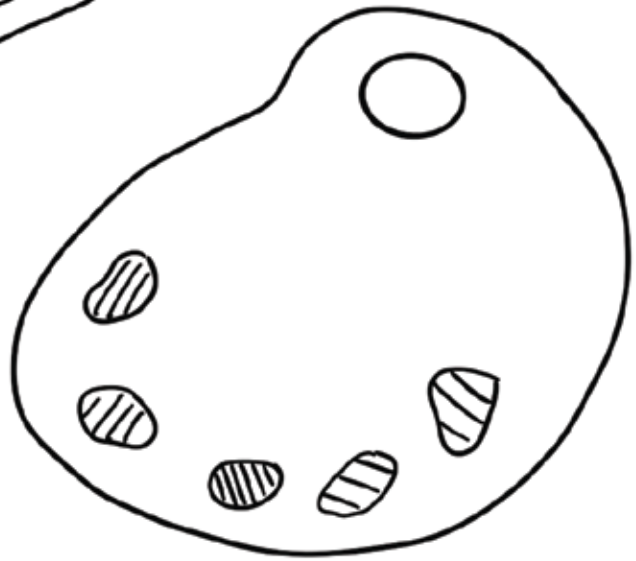
all in all, the paths i took through the material were
the just the ones that made sense to me, and what
makes the most sense to each person is dictated by
who they are as a person adn what they've experienced.





through this class and the weekly assignments, i was able to express my personal perspectives and experiences through new and creative outlets,

as well as engage with others' unique experiences and understandings of the self and the world.



as a result, i now experience and see myself and the world a little differently from before.



for that,
i am very thankful!
i am also proud of the work i've done
for this class which, i'll admit, is not something i can say
for every class i've taken (shh, don't tell).

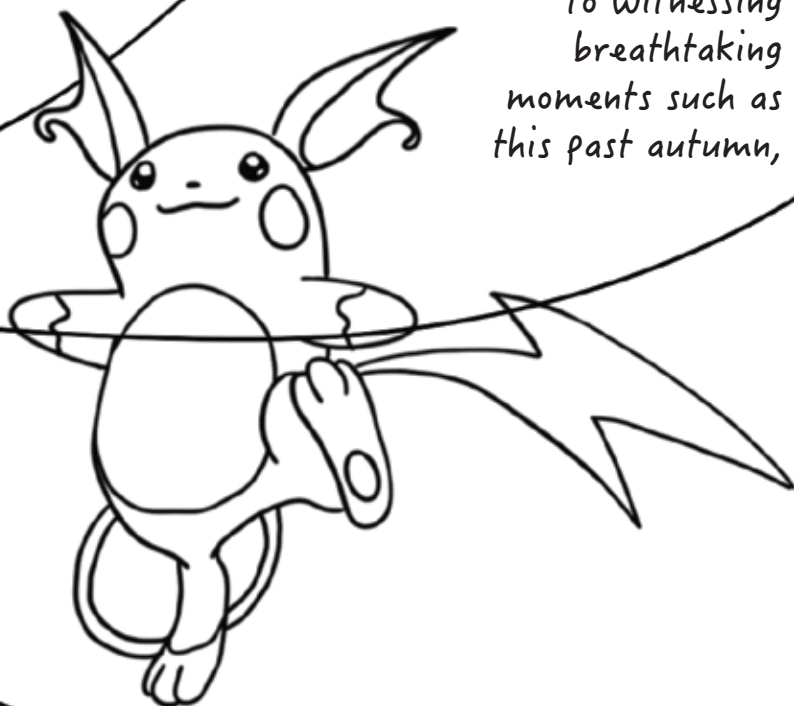
from taking classes such as this one,



*to the daily interactions
i have with those
around me,*



*to witnessing
breathtaking
moments such as
this past autumn,*



*and everything in between,
my understanding of myself
and the world around me is
constantly evolving in
unpredictable ways.*

i don't know how or what i'm going to evolve into next.



hopefully...

well, we'll just have to see.